

ML Howell

Senior Product Designer • San Francisco, CA

High-craft product designer with 8 years across product and brand, building daily with AI.

CONTACT

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EXPERIENCE

Founding Product Designer • Guac (YC 2023)

Jun 2024 – Mar 2026

- Founding designer building AI-powered tools for grocery stores; helped grow the company from \$0 to \$1M+ ARR, shipping products to three multi-store chains (21 stores live, 60-store chain onboarding).
- Led interaction design of iOS, Android, and web products spanning store ordering, forecasting and product recommendations, production ingredient breakdown, production planning schedules, and recipe management.
- Drove features from concept and wireframes to prototyping and final spec. Partnered with engineers in the codebase (Claude Code, HTML/CSS) to implement designs.
- Designed AI forecasting to build user trust, letting store teams drill into the data behind each AI-generated forecast, so they could verify it.
- Led brand design of conference booths, sales decks, printed materials, and website.

Product Designer • Afresh

Nov 2022 – May 2024

- Owned the design system through a full redesign, raising craft, improving product consistency, and accelerating team speed across a team of 8 designers.
- Led design of user onboarding, including the main UX flow, in-store training assets, and training platform.
- Partnered with PMs and engineers across multiple product squads to conduct user research. Traveled to a key LA customer post-launch to diagnose issues, observing across multiple days, and bringing findings back to PM and engineering.

Senior Brand Designer • Afresh

Nov 2021 – Nov 2022

- Led a full brand refresh as the company scaled to a \$115M Series B, partnering with agency and 3D artists to elevate the brand. Extended the work across marketing, sales, social media, and events.
- Led brand design of conference booths, video, sales decks, reports, and microsites.

Brand Designer • theSkimm

Feb 2019 – Nov 2021

- Designed interactive websites and branded materials.
- Redesigned brand illustrations during a refresh, developing templates and guidelines.

PROJECTS

Doodles • doodle.mary-louise.com

- Designed and built an AI doodle web app. 80+ users, 10k social impressions

Street Cleaning Parking • streetcleaningparking.com

- iOS app with 150 paid users, featured in [ABC News](#) and [SF Standard](#)

TOOLS & SKILLS

Tooling: Figma, Claude Code, Adobe Creative Suite, HTML/CSS, Midjourney
Skills: Interaction Design, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, User Research, Brand Design, Typography, Illustration, A/B Testing

EDUCATION

MA in Graphic Design • Maryland Institute College of Art, Baltimore, Maryland

BA in English Literature • University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, Scotland